

Richard Sparkes

Personal Information

Email: richardsparkes@live.ie
Citizenship: Irish
Languages: English (native), French (intermediate), Irish (basic)
Primary Research Interests: Monetary Economics, Price-Setting, Inflation, Macroeconomics and Bayesian Macroeconometrics
Secondary Research Interests: DSGE Models and Microeconometrics

Education

University of St. Andrews 2022 - 2026 (expected)
PhD in Economics
Thesis: Essays on Price-Change Dynamics and Monetary Policy Transmission
Thesis Supervisors: Dr. Özge Senay and Dr. Jonathan Swarbrick

Université Paris 1 Panthéon-Sorbonne & Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona 2018 - 2020
Joint M.Sc. in Models and Methods of Quantitative Economics
Thesis: Measuring Price Rigidity and Monetary Non-Neutrality after the Great Recession
Thesis Supervisor: Dr. Hugo Rodríguez Mendizábal

Trinity College Dublin 2014 - 2018
B.A. (Hons) in Mathematics and Economics (Double Major)

Professional Experience

Bank of England September - December 2026
PhD Research Intern, Monetary and Financial Conditions Division July - September 2024

- Researched the macroeconomic effects of exogenous increases in the money supply
- Designed Bayesian structural vector autoregressive models to undertake this economic research
- Constructed aggregate divisia monetary data for the UK economy to undertake this economic research

European Commission April - August 2022
Poland Statistical Assistant, DG for Economic and Financial Affairs

- Produced the European Commission's official GDP and HICP summer 2022 forecast for Poland
- Designed MATLAB code to automatically create PDFs containing graphs of key economic indicators for Poland
- Designed nowcasting forecasting models in EViews for estimating quarterly GDP growth rates in Poland

European Central Bank July 2020 - January 2022
Research Analyst, Monetary Policy Strategy Division

- Responsible for running and maintaining the ECB's purchasing programme projections model in MATLAB
- Contributed to the preparation of the Monetary Policy Briefings for the Governing Council meetings
- Co-authored boxes in Quarterly Monetary Analysis and Monetary Policy Briefing on asset purchase programmes
- Author for the Financial Developments section of the ECB Economic Bulletin Issues (5-8, 2021)
- Responsible for coordinating the work of a team of employees within the Monetary Policy Strategy Datacentre
- Designed and coded a MATLAB model which projects the level of excess liquidity in the Eurozone banking system
- Coded models to project the purchasing programme's capital key deviations, policy space and duration extraction

Central Bank of Ireland June - September 2019
Intern, European Central Bank Policy Team, Financial Markets Division

- Prepared written and verbal briefings for Irish members of the ECB's Markets Operations Committee
- Wrote monthly Policy Status reports summarising consultations to Eurosystem committees
- Wrote status reports on Liquidity in Resolution, Central Bank Digital Currencies and the Euro short-term rate

- Rotated across Credit Strategy and FX Strategy desks within the Global Markets Research team
- Presented my research of financial risk embedded in China's shadow banking system to board of senior management
- Daily tasks included writing market strategy updates, FX rates trade ideas and assisting in publication preparation

Working Papers and Work in Progress

Price-Change Dynamics across the Business Cycle: Evidence from Market Reference Prices (**Job Market Paper**)

Centralised Timing and Localised Sizing: Price-Setting in U.S. Retail Chains

Identifying the Transmission Mechanism of Central Bank Lending Operations

Identifying Money Supply Shocks with Narrative Sign Restrictions
with Mauricio Salgado-Moreno (Bank of England)

Conference Presentations

Money, Macro and Finance Society Annual Conference, <i>Lancaster University</i>	2026
Money, Macro and Finance Society PhD Conference, <i>Loughborough University</i>	2025
European Seminar on Bayesian Econometrics, <i>University of Örebro</i>	2024

Teaching Experience

Intermediate Macroeconomics Graduate Teaching Assistant, <i>University of St. Andrews</i>	2023
Mathematics for Economists Graduate Teaching Assistant, <i>University of St. Andrews</i>	2023
Macroeconomics Graduate Teaching Assistant, <i>University of St. Andrews</i>	2023
Mathematics Teaching Assistant, <i>Ringsend College</i>	2018
Mathematics Teaching Volunteer, <i>Trinity College Dublin Voluntary Tuition Programme</i>	2018

PhD Training Schools

Local Projection Methods for Time Series and Panel Data, <i>Center for Monetary and Financial Studies</i>	2025
Bayesian Macroeconometrics, <i>Barcelona School of Economics</i>	2024
Tools for Macroeconomists, the Essentials and Advanced Tools	2024
Time Series Models for Macroeconomic Analysis, <i>Barcelona School of Economics</i>	2023
Bayesian Structural Vector Autoregressions, <i>University of East Anglia</i>	2023
Bayesian Methods in Economics and Finance, <i>University Ca' Foscari</i>	2023
Open Economy DSGE Modelling with Applications to Emerging Economies, <i>City University of London</i>	2023
Macroeconomics and the Science and Art of DSGE Modelling, <i>University of Surrey</i>	2022

Skills

Programming Skills: Python, MATLAB, R, Dynare, Stata and EViews
Statistical Software Skills: Bloomberg, Refinitiv and Haver Analytics
Typesetting Skills: Microsoft Office and Latex

Achievements

Awarded research grant of £3,500 from Scotland's Futures Series	2023
Awarded PhD Scholarship of £55,827, University of St. Andrews, School of Economics and Finance	2022
Completed the Chartered Institute for Securities & Investment's Capital Markets Program	2018
Represented Ireland in the CFA Institute Research Challenge EMEA Finals	2016
Piano - Grade VIII standard, Royal Irish Academy of Music	2011